

DELHI | Going Up in Smoke

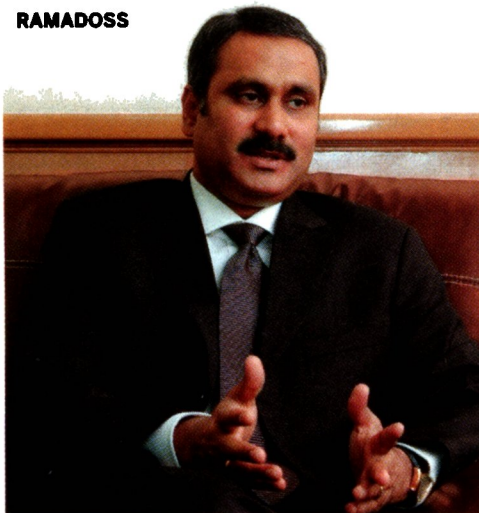
Anbumani Ramadoss, credited with aridding public spaces of the stench of cigarette smoke as the Union health minister, can now feel a whiff of neglect. Ramadoss, who resigned in April, believes that the UPA Government is now attempting to sabotage his project for enhancing statutory warnings on tobacco products by altering the rules notified under the Cigarettes and Other Tobacco Products Packaging and Labelling Rules 2008. This would result in dilution of pictorial warnings—like skull and bones on beedi packets—and reduction of space meant for warnings on cigarette packets.

Ramadoss has shot off a letter to Prime Minister Manmohan Singh, asking him to rescue the rules enacted during his tenure as health minister. Ramadoss says that the decisions of the Group of Ministers to reduce the statutory warning space to just 40 per cent of the pack will fail to deter tobacco users. "The

rules have drawn flak from both national and international quarters for their soft approach towards the tobacco industry," says Ramadoss.

by Shafi Rahman

RAMADOSS



RAVISH SAHANI

Left Spin

When Left leaders met J. Jayalalithaa in Chennai, she told an amused Prakash Karat that cricket was once played only by women before it was hijacked by men. The oblique message: the post-poll political game is not available for hijacking attempts.

BANGALORE | Smog in the City



BANGALORE'S LANDSCAPE IS NOW CROWDED AND SMOGGY

Chief Minister B.S. Yeddyurappa may be flying high in his hired helicopter all over Karnataka, but landing in the state capital is no dream. Yeddyurappa's pilots are finding it difficult to fly through the dark smog that hangs over the city,

thanks to fumes from its two million vehicles. So much so that the state Environmental Pollution (Prevention and Control) Authority has sent a recommendation to the apex court requesting that CNG should be used more in vehicles than diesel and petrol to bring down the city's pollution levels. The state Government spends a whopping Rs 1 lakh a

day for Yeddyurappa's travel and Rs 3 crore has already been spent on his air travel ever since he took over as chief minister in May 2008. Oh well, whatever it takes to bring Bangalore's pollution under control.

by Stephen David

MUMBAI |

Patience Pays

Finally, there can be resolution and closure for medical malpractice cases in Maharashtra. After nearly a decade, the Maharashtra Medical Council (MMC) is set to get a new committee to listen to grievances of disgruntled patients, which have been pending since 2003. After ten years, the elections to the MMC were held on April 26. The committee will comprise of nine doctors from the Indian Medical Association, Association of Medical Consultants and



HEMANT CHAWLA

the Maharashtra Association of Gazetted Medical Officers. The MMC acts as a quasi-judicial body, which can register, suspend or cancel licences of doctors. The committee will look into pending and fresh cases of patients' grievances. The state Government will nominate candidates from universities, Directorate of Health Services, directorate of medical education and research areas to serve on the committee. by Aditi Pal